6. To promote and support law reform
7. To conduct seminars and organise talks on legal topics by eminent jurists and publish journals and papers of legal interest
8. To organise legal aid to the poor
9. To manage and invest its funds
10. To provide for the election of its members
11. To visit and inspect universities in accordance with the directions issued by the BCI
12. To perform all other functions conferred on it under this Act
13. To do all other things necessary for discharging the above functions

A SBC may establish funds for the following purposes:

1. Giving financial assistance to organise welfare schemes for the indigent, disabled or other advocates
2. Giving legal aid or advice
3. Establishing law libraries

Further, a SBC may also receive grants, donations, gifts and benefactions for the above purposes.

Types Of Advocates[2a]

The Advocates Act, 1961 provides for two categories of Advocates viz., Senior Advocates and other advocates, who are entitled to practice law before the Courts. The exercise of powers vested in the Supreme Court and the High Courts to designate an Advocate as a Senior Advocate is circumscribed by the requirement of due satisfaction that the Advocate concerned fulfills the qualifications prescribed under the Advocates Act, 1961. In terms of the Advocates Act, 1961, an advocate may, with his/her consent, be designated as senior advocate if the Supreme Court or a High Court is of opinion that by virtue of his/her ability standing at the Bar or special knowledge or experience in law, he/she is deserving of such distinction.

There are three categories of Advocates who are entitled to practise law before the Supreme Court. These are explained as follows:

1. Senior Advocate

A 'Senior Advocate' means any advocate so designated under the Advocates Act, 1961, and all such advocates whose names were borne on the roll of the senior advocates of the Court immediately before the commencement of the Advocates Act, 1961. The Supreme Court Rules, 2013, deals with designation of Advocates as Senior Advocates. These Rules provide that the Chief Justice of India and the Judges may, with the consent of the Advocate, designate an Advocate as Senior Advocate, if in their opinion, by virtue of his/her ability, standing at the Bar or special knowledge or experience in law, the said Advocate is deserving of such distinction. Apart from the designation of Advocates as Senior Advocates, retired Chief Justices/Judges of the High Courts are also considered for designation as Senior Advocates in the